

Existential Perspective

Existentialism:

- Existentialism focuses on man's search for meaning and purpose in life.
- Existentialism is a way of thinking that focuses on what it means for people to exist. It is philosophical movement.
- They premise that people must make choices about their life while knowing they are mortal is what existentialism is all about.
- It was started by the Danish philosophical **Soren Kierkegaard** (1813-1855).
- Existential philosophy started with the writings of Kierkegaard and Nietzsche.
- **Existence:**
- The process of continual growth and change supersedes Essence, the state of merely being.
- Human are both objective and subjective, therefore they cannot merely be but must question their own existence.
- We ultimately are solely responsible for the state of our own existence.
- Phenomena can only be fully authentic through experience.

Assumptions of Existential Perspective:

- All persons have the capacity for self-awareness.
- As free beings, everyone must accept the responsibility that comes with freedom.
- Each person has a unique identity that can only be known through relationships with others.
- Each person must continually recreate himself. The meaning of life and of existence is never fixed; rather, it constantly changes.
- Death is a basic human condition that gives significance to life
- Existential perspective assumes the belief that people's problems come from not exercising choice and judgment enough--or well enough--to forge meaning in their lives, and that each individual is responsible for making meaning out of life.

Contributors of this perspective

Apart from Kierkegaard and Nietzsche, following are some contributors.

1. Martin Heidegger	2. Ludwig Binswanger	3. Rollo May	4. George Kelly
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Main key points:

Aim of education :

- To help students understand and appreciate themselves as a unique individual who accept complete responsibility for their thoughts, feelings and actions.
- To educate the whole person, not just the mind, since feeling is not divorced from reason in decision making.
- To help the learner become fully his authentic self.

Emotional development:

Capacity of direction

Curriculum-Knowledge:

Should be free choice, problem solving situation, natural talent freedom.

Method of teaching:

Should be freedom, one to one relation.

Teacher:

Help to define their essence. They can ask questions, express their thoughts, sophistic environment.

Discipline:

Class of students to realize their own existence, to transform into environment that enables governments to take responsibility for their own existence.

Existential Therapy:

The existentialist, is more interested in helping the client find philosophical meaning in the face of anxiety by choosing to think and act authentically and responsibly. According to existential therapy, the central problems people face are embedded in anxiety over loneliness, isolation, despair, and, ultimately, death. Creativity, love, authenticity, and free will are recognized as potential avenues toward transformation, enabling people to live meaningful lives in the face of uncertainty and suffering. Everyone suffers losses (e.g., friends die, relationships end), and these losses cause anxiety because they are reminders of human limitations and inevitable death. The existential therapist recognizes that human influence is shaped by biology, culture, and luck. Existential therapy assumes the belief that people's problems come from not exercising choice and judgment enough--or well enough--to forge meaning in their lives, and that each individual is responsible for making meaning out of life. Outside forces, however, may contribute to the individual's limited ability to exercise choice and live a meaningful life. For the existential therapist, life is much more of a confrontation with negative internal forces than it is for the humanistic therapist.

Comparison of Humanistic and Existential Psychology

Humanistic	Existential
Humans are basically good.	Humans are neutral.
	Humans have freedom to choose the nature of our existence.
Human basic motive is to achieve actualization.	Basic motive is to create meaning in life by making choices.

